event: first, the India selection held at the Delhi Golf Club, followed by the Asian selection in Melbourne, concluding with the final selection in Aberdeen. Being awarded the Doug Sanders golf scholarship at the Abilene Christian University, in Houston, Texas, meant that Jeev could combine formal education with a sports curriculum.

All this travelling around meant that he was missing classes at school and he still had to complete his education. The Shivalik Public School, however, was most supportive, and arranged extra classes and special tuitions for him. He completed his Class 10 at this school, and then transferred to DAV College, Sector 10, Chandigarh, for the final two years. In 1991 he passed out of DAV College and left for a new life in Houston, Texas.

Jeev's years in the United States were highly successful ones. He played several NCAA (National Collegiate Athletic Association) division tournaments where he represented his university. I was filled with pride when he won the NCAA II Division championship and when his team came first in the Inter-University Golf Championship in 1993. In the same year, he graduated from Abilene Christian University with an associate degree in business administration and returned to India where he turned pro. Thereafter, he won numerous tournaments on the Asian and European tours. He was also the first Indian to qualify for the European Tour. My hopes for my son had exceeded all expectations.

Today, I am glad that Dharma Vira persuaded me to start playing golf, because it was my fascination for the game that lured Jeev to it. His quick aptitude and inherent skill combined with his passion and determination have made him the gifted sportsman that he is. When I accompany Jeev on his tours, whether it is in India, Europe, the US or elsewhere, and walk beside him when he's playing, my knowledge of the game allows me the freedom to offer not only fatherly advice but professional pointers as well. Besides, it is through him that I relive my days of glory. I was on cloud nine when Jeev was given the Arjuna Award (1999) followed by the Padma Shri (2007).

It has been an amazing journey and today, I am a proud husband, father and grandfather. Nimmi and I keep ourselves busy running the Milkha Charitable Trust in Chandigarh, where we provide humanitarian services to the poor and needy, particularly penniless sportspeople and their families. These are causes that are very close to our hearts.